

Bank Consumer Complaints Analysis

Identifying product, issue and response-time risk areas in US consumer banking using the CFPB Consumer Complaint Database

Item	Detail
Data source	CFPB Consumer Complaint Database (public API)
Period analysed	October 2024 to August 2026 (23 complete months)
Records analysed	596,121 complaints across 6 product groups and 2,428 companies
Tools	Python (pandas, matplotlib), Google Colab, Microsoft Power BI

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1. Company Background

Data owner: the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB). The CFPB is a US federal agency created under the Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act of 2010 to protect consumers in the financial marketplace. One of its functions is to collect consumer complaints about financial products, forward them to the company concerned, and publish the complaint data publicly with personal information removed.

Project context (simulated business scenario). The project is framed as work done by an analyst in the Customer Experience and Compliance Analytics team of a large retail financial services provider (a bank, card issuer or payments company). The team needs an industry benchmark: what customers complain about across the market, where peers struggle, and what to fix first. The public CFPB database provides that benchmark.

2. Business Problem

Financial institutions receive thousands of complaints every month. Raw counts alone do not tell leadership:

- which products and issues generate the most dissatisfaction,
- which companies respond poorly or late,
- whether a rise in volume is a real service problem or a temporary spike,
- and where fixing one thing would remove the most complaints.

Problem statement. *Which banking products and issues cause the most customer complaints, which companies respond too slowly, and what should an institution fix first?*

3. Business Objective

#	Objective
1	Measure complaint volume and trend across six consumer banking product groups
2	Identify the top issues driving complaints, overall and within each product
3	Evaluate response quality through timely-response rate and relief rate, by product and company
4	Find and explain anomalies (such as January 2025) so they do not distort decisions
5	Provide prioritised, evidence-based recommendations with measurable KPIs
6	Deliver an interactive Power BI dashboard for non-technical stakeholders

4. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	What they need from the analysis
Head of Customer Experience	Which issues frustrate customers most and which fixes reduce complaints
Compliance and Risk Officer	Early warning of regulatory risk: late responses, fraud and unauthorised-transaction complaints
Product Managers (cards, accounts, mortgages, student and vehicle loans, digital payments)	Complaint drivers for their own product
Complaint-handling and Operations Manager	Response-time performance, relief outcomes, channel mix
Senior Leadership and Board	A one-page summary and priorities
Data and BI team	Clean dataset, documented pipeline, reusable dashboard
Regulators (external, indirect)	Industry-wide complaint patterns
Customers (end beneficiaries)	Faster responses and fewer problems

5. Business KPIs

KPI	Definition	Result (Oct 2024 to Aug 2026)
Total Complaints	Count of unique complaints	596,121
Timely Response %	Share of complaints where the company responded on time	96.9%
Late Responses	Complaints with a late response	about 18,000
Relief Rate %	Share closed with monetary or non-monetary relief	16.5%
Companies	Distinct companies complained about	2,428
Top-10 Company Share	Share of complaints held by the 10 largest companies	48.2%
Typical Monthly Volume	Median monthly complaints	23,268
Same-day Forwarding %	Complaints the CFPB forwarded to the company on the day received	88.5%

6. Domain Knowledge

6.1 Industry terminology

Term	Meaning
Complaint	A consumer's written report of a problem with a financial product or company
Product / sub-product	The type of financial service (for example, Credit card; Store credit card)
Issue / sub-issue	What went wrong (for example, Managing an account; Fraud or scam)
Company response	How the company closed the complaint (explanation, relief, no relief)
Timely response	Whether the company answered within the required timeframe
Monetary / non-monetary relief	A refund or compensation / a non-cash fix such as a corrected record
Redress	Compensation to harmed consumers, often ordered by a regulator
Unauthorised transaction	A payment the account holder did not approve
P2P payments	Peer-to-peer payment apps such as Cash App, Zelle and Venmo
Servicer	The company that collects payments and manages a loan (common for mortgages and student loans)
Delinquency / repossession	Missed loan payments / a lender taking back a financed vehicle
Consumer report / furnisher	A credit-bureau file / a company that supplies data to credit bureaus
Dispute / chargeback	A request to reverse a card transaction
UDAAP	Unfair, Deceptive or Abusive Acts or Practices, the legal standard used against misconduct

6.2 Business workflow: the complaint life cycle

1. **The consumer submits** a complaint through the web, phone, referral or postal mail.
2. **The CFPB reviews and routes** it to the company, usually the same day (88.5% of complaints in this dataset).
3. **The company responds.** Companies generally respond within 15 days, and some complaints receive a final response later.
4. **The consumer can review** the response.
5. **The complaint is published** in the public database after the company responds, or after 15 days, whichever comes first, with personal information removed.
6. **Regulators and analysts** use the data to spot trends, supervise companies and guide enforcement.

6.3 Common industry challenges

- Volume spikes caused by events, enforcement news or social media.
- Fraud and scams on instant-payment and P2P platforms.
- Hard-to-reach customer support, especially app-only support.
- Servicer transitions and backlogs, visible in the student-loan response data.
- Billing and dispute handling on cards.
- Credit-report accuracy: incorrect-information issues appear even inside bank products.

- Inconsistent complaint categorisation across companies.
- Reporting lag: the newest weeks of a public complaint database are always incomplete.

6.4 Industry regulations (United States)

Regulation	Relevance
Consumer Financial Protection Act (part of Dodd-Frank, 2010)	Created the CFPB, prohibits unfair, deceptive or abusive practices (UDAAP) and supports the complaint process
Electronic Fund Transfer Act (Regulation E)	Error resolution and unauthorised electronic transfers
Truth in Lending Act (Regulation Z) and Fair Credit Billing Act	Card and loan disclosures; billing-error disputes
Fair Credit Reporting Act (FCRA)	Accuracy of credit-report information and dispute rights
Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA)	Debt-collector conduct
Real Estate Settlement Procedures Act (Regulation X)	Mortgage servicing and settlement rules
Equal Credit Opportunity Act (ECOA)	Non-discrimination in lending

6.5 Business metrics used in complaint analytics

Complaint volume and share, month-on-month change, timely-response %, relief rate %, response-time distribution, concentration (top-N share), and anomaly ratio (peak month versus median month).

7. Dataset Overview

Item	Detail
Source	CFPB Consumer Complaint Database, public API at consumerfinance.gov (no API key required)
Collection method	Python (requests, pandas) in Google Colab; monthly CSV downloads validated against the API's own row counts
Products included	7 official product names grouped into 6: Checking or savings account; Credit card; Prepaid card; Mortgage; Vehicle loan or lease; Student loan; Money transfer, virtual currency, or money service
Deliberately excluded	Credit reporting, debt collection, payday and personal loans, and debt management. In the month checked (August 2026), credit-reporting complaints (623,453) outnumbered all banking products combined (27,163), and they concern credit bureaus rather than banks
Raw records downloaded	630,670 rows and 15 columns
Duplicates removed	16,176
Incomplete-month rows removed	18,373 (September 2026 and 1 October 2026)
Final records analysed	596,121
Features in the exported file	23 columns (15 raw columns plus engineered columns, minus long-text columns)
Time span	1 October 2024 to 31 August 2026 (23 complete months)
Target variable	None. This is descriptive and diagnostic analytics. <code>timely_flag</code> and <code>relief_flag</code> act as outcome measures and could become targets in a future predictive model

Missing values. The table below was measured on the first extract (5 products, 431,761 rows), and the pattern is the same in the final data. After cleaning, no column in the final dataset had remaining blanks.

Column	Missing	Meaning and treatment
tags	about 85%	Blank means no tag (only Older American and Servicemember are tagged). Filled with "None"
company_public_response	about 70%	Optional company statement. Filled with "Not provided"
sub_issue	about 28%	Not every issue has a sub-issue. Filled with "Not specified"
state	about 1%	Genuinely missing. Filled with "Unknown"
All other columns	0%	None

Known limitations

1. Raw complaint counts favour large companies, and no customer-base data is available to normalise them.
2. Complaints about depository institutions with under \$10 billion in assets are referred to other regulators and are not published, so small banks are absent.
3. A complaint reflects customer dissatisfaction, not proven wrongdoing.
4. The newest weeks of any extract are subject to publication lag.

8. Data Dictionary

Column	Type	Description
complaint_id	Integer (ID)	Unique CFPB complaint number
date_received	Date	Date the CFPB received the complaint
date_sent_to_company	Date	Date the CFPB forwarded the complaint to the company
year	Integer	Year of date_received
quarter	Text	Q1 to Q4
month_num	Integer	Month number, 1 to 12
month_name	Text	Jan to Dec
year_month	Date	First day of the month of date_received, used for monthly trends
weekday	Text	Day of the week
product	Text	Official CFPB product name (7 values)
product_group	Text	Simplified dashboard group (6 values)
sub_product	Text	More detailed product type ("Not specified" if blank)
issue	Text	Main problem reported
sub_issue	Text	More detail ("Not specified" if blank)
company	Text	Company the complaint is about, with spelling standardised
state	Text	US state of the consumer ("Unknown" if missing)
submitted_via	Text	Channel: Web, Referral, Phone or Postal mail
tags	Text	Older American, Servicemember, or None
company_response_to_consumer	Text	How the company closed the complaint
timely_response	Text	Yes or No
timely_flag	Integer	1 if timely, else 0 (its average is Timely %)
relief_flag	Integer	1 if closed with monetary or non-monetary relief, else 0 (its average is Relief %)
days_to_company	Numeric	Days from receipt to forwarding

9. Business Questions

#	Question	Short answer
1	Is complaint volume rising or falling?	A typical month has about 23,000 complaints. January 2025 spiked to 84,295, and the underlying level drifted up after it
2	Which products generate the most complaints?	Credit and prepaid cards (31.4%), bank accounts (26.8%), money transfer and digital (19.3%)
3	Which companies have the most complaints?	Block, Inc. (59,037; 9.9%), then Capital One, JPMorgan Chase, Wells Fargo and Bank of America. The top 10 hold 48.2%
4	What are customers most upset about?	Managing an account (88,292), other transaction problems (58,752), purchase problems on a statement (45,448)
5	Which products and companies respond late?	Student loans: 71.3% timely against 97.6% to 99.3% elsewhere. MOHELA 45.5%
6	Which products end in relief for the customer?	Cards 30.3% and accounts 17.0%; mortgages 4.6% and student loans 1.6%
7	What caused the January 2025 spike?	Block and Early Warning Services made up 57% of the month; one issue made up 50%
8	How do customers complain?	Web 92.9%, Referral 3.2%, Phone 3.1%, Postal mail 0.8%
9	Which states have the most complaints?	CA, TX, FL, NY and GA lead; the top 10 hold 62.2%
10	Is the delay on the regulator's side or the company's?	Routing is fast (88.5% same day), so delays sit on the company side

10. Python Analysis

10.1 Pipeline

Stage	What was done	Why
Collect	Pulled each month through the API and compared the downloaded row count with the count the API reported	Proves completeness and makes the run resumable
Clean	Standardised column names, removed duplicates, parsed dates, trimmed text, merged company spellings, labelled blanks, created helper columns	Reliable counts and Power BI-friendly fields
Explore	Seven charts and several summary tables	Find patterns and anomalies
Export	One clean CSV (596,121 rows) and a data dictionary	Feeds Power BI

Helper columns created: `timely_flag`, `relief_flag`, `days_to_company`, `year`, `quarter`, `month_num`, `month_name`, `year_month`, `weekday`, `product_group`.

10.2 Data quality problems found and fixed

Problem	How it was found	Fix
Credit cards returned zero rows	Product counts showed only 5 products	The API lists "Credit card" and "Prepaid card" separately; names corrected
16,176 duplicate complaints	Cleaning step	The API treats the end date as inclusive, so each month also pulled the 1st of the next month. Deduplicated on <code>complaint_id</code>
Latest month incomplete	The monthly line fell sharply at the end; daily counts confirmed it	Weekday volume held at about 1,000 to 1,100 a day until 16 September, then fell to 80 to 150. That matches the CFPB rule of publishing a complaint after the company responds or after 15 days. September 2026 was excluded, leaving 23 complete months

10.3 Key numbers

Measure	Value
Total complaints analysed	596,121
Period	October 2024 to August 2026
Companies	2,428 (2,429 before spelling standardisation)
Biggest product group	Credit and Prepaid Card (31.4%)
Top company	Block, Inc. (9.9%)
Top issue	Managing an account
Overall timely response	96.9%
Overall relief rate	16.5%
Peak month	January 2025 (84,295 complaints)

10.4 Chart-by-chart insights and recommendations

Chart 1: Complaints per month

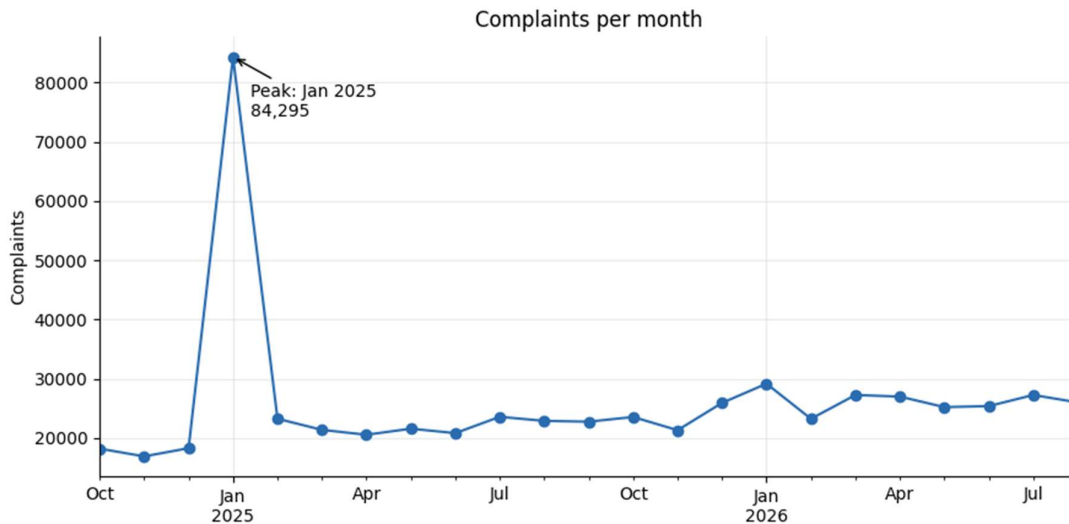


Figure 1: Complaints per month, October 2024 to August 2026

Insight: A typical month has about 23,000 complaints. January 2025 reached 84,295, which is 3.6 times typical. Block (31,223) and Early Warning Services (16,723) made up 57% of that month, and one issue, "Other transaction problem" (42,521), made up 50%. Public reporting from Consumer Reports connects the early-2025 surge in Zelle and Cash App complaints to social media posts urging people to file them, and the CFPB announced its order against Block in mid-January 2025 after suing Early Warning Services in December 2024. The spike is therefore consistent with a campaign and news-driven event rather than a sudden fall in service quality, although the dataset itself cannot prove the cause. Navy Federal Credit Union (7,775) and Capital One (5,955) also ranked high that month, which this analysis does not explain. Outside the spike, monthly volume rose from roughly 17,000 to 18,000 in late 2024 to roughly 25,000 to 27,000 in mid-2026.

Recommendation: Always report trends with and without January 2025. Set an alert when a company's or issue's daily complaints exceed about three times its normal level, and investigate the underlying upward drift.

Chart 2: Complaints by product group

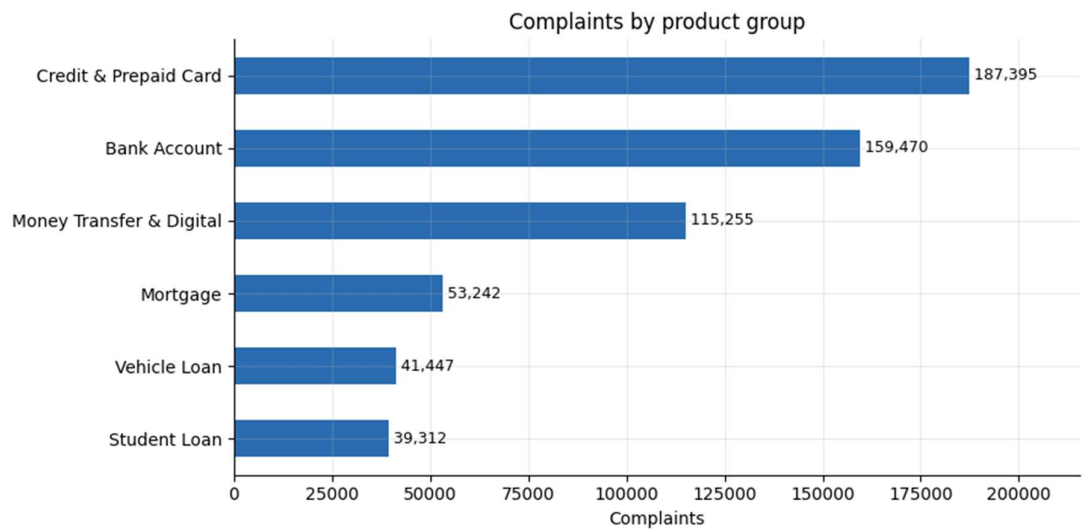


Figure 2: Complaints by product group

Insight: Credit and prepaid cards (187,395), bank accounts (159,470) and money transfer and digital (115,255) hold 77.5% of all complaints. Mortgages (8.9%), vehicle loans (7.0%) and student loans (6.6%) are small by volume.

Recommendation: Aim volume-reduction work at cards, accounts and digital payments. Do not ignore the small products, because student loans and mortgages have the weakest response quality (see Chart 5).

Chart 3: Top 10 companies

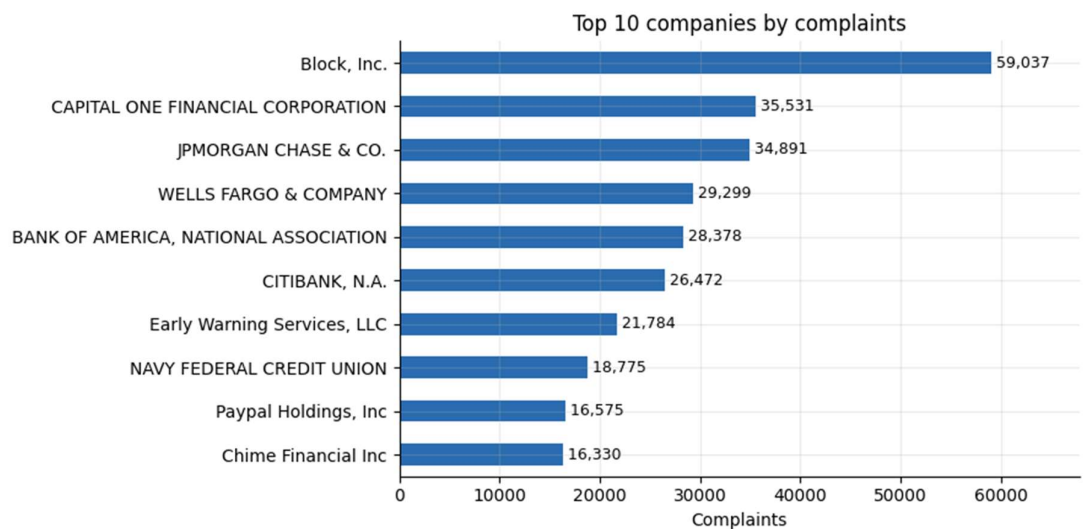


Figure 3: Top 10 companies by complaints

Insight: Block, Inc. leads with 59,037 complaints (9.9%), and the top 10 companies hold 48.2% of all complaints. Four of the ten are non-traditional providers (Block, Early Warning Services, PayPal, Chime), alongside Capital One, JPMorgan Chase, Wells Fargo, Bank of America, Citibank and Navy Federal Credit Union. More than half of Block's complaints (31,223 of 59,037, or 52.9%) arrived in the single month of January 2025, and Block's timely-response rate is a healthy 98.5%, so its volume is not a responsiveness problem.

Recommendation: Never rank companies on raw counts alone. Normalise by customer base and show rankings with and without January 2025. Digital-first providers need bank-grade complaint handling.

Chart 4: Top 8 issues



Figure 4: Top 8 issues

Insight: Managing an account (88,292; 14.8%), Other transaction problem (58,752; 9.9%) and Problem with a purchase shown on your statement (45,448; 7.6%) together make up 32.3% of all complaints. Incorrect information on your report (31,815; 5.3%) shows that credit-report accuracy is a problem even inside bank products. Fraud or scam accounts for 20,732 complaints.

Recommendation: Fix the top three first: account access, holds and closures; transaction-error handling; and card-dispute workflows. A 10% cut in the top two issues alone would remove about 14,700 complaints.

Top three issues inside each product group

Product group	Top issues (complaints)
Bank Account	Managing an account (88,292); Closing an account (20,035); Problem with a lender or other company charging your account (20,008)
Credit and Prepaid Card	Problem with a purchase shown on your statement (45,448); Incorrect information on your report (21,649); Getting a credit card (20,730)
Money Transfer and Digital	Other transaction problem (58,752); Fraud or scam (20,732); Unauthorized transactions or other transaction problem (10,956)
Mortgage	Trouble during payment process (26,934); Struggling to pay mortgage (13,796); Applying for a mortgage or refinancing (5,340)
Student Loan	Dealing with your lender or servicer (22,912); Struggling to repay your loan (7,671); Incorrect information on your report (4,486)
Vehicle Loan	Managing the loan or lease (11,973); Repossession (11,235); Problems at the end of the loan or lease (5,910)

Insight: Four of the six product groups are dominated by one issue that makes up 51% to 58% of the group's complaints: Managing an account (55% of bank-account complaints), Other transaction problem (51% of money-transfer complaints), Trouble during payment process (51% of mortgage complaints) and Dealing with your lender or servicer (58% of student-loan complaints). Cards (24%) and vehicle loans (30%) are more evenly spread.

Recommendation: Give each product one accountable owner for its dominant issue. Early hardship outreach could reduce mortgage payment-trouble and vehicle repossession complaints.

Chart 5: Relief rate and response quality by product

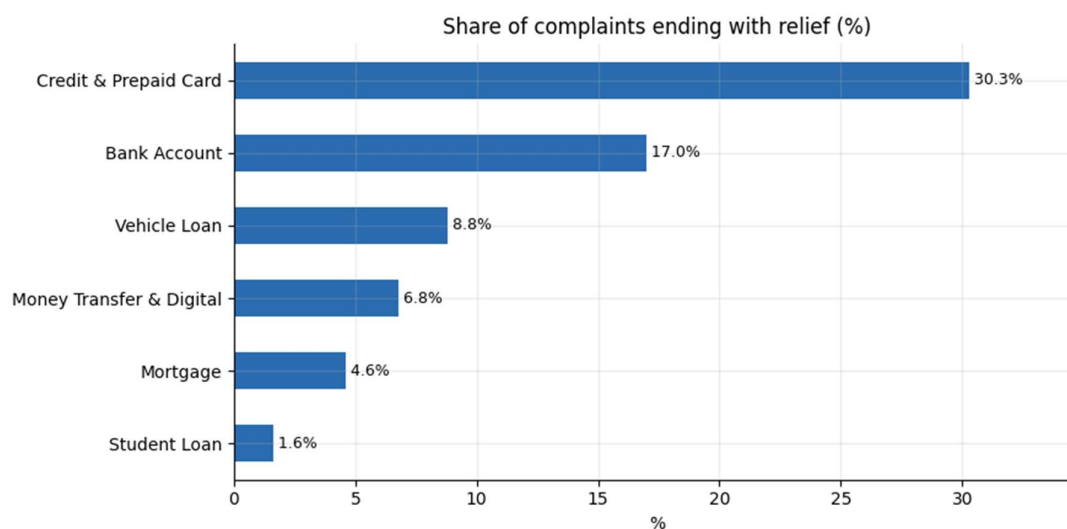


Figure 5: Share of complaints ending with relief, by product group

Product group	Complaints	Timely %	Relief %
Credit and Prepaid Card	187,395	98.9	30.3
Bank Account	159,470	99.3	17.0
Money Transfer and Digital	115,255	98.6	6.8
Mortgage	53,242	97.6	4.6
Vehicle Loan	41,447	98.2	8.8
Student Loan	39,312	71.3	1.6

Companies with the lowest timely-response rate (66 companies with at least 1,000 complaints were assessed)

Company	Complaints	Timely %
Servicer under contract with Federal Student Aid	2,870	0.00
MOHELA	14,771	45.54
Incomm Holdings Inc.	1,282	61.54
FinCo Services Inc DBA Current	1,355	86.27
Robinhood Markets Inc.	3,389	91.92

Insight: Overall, 16.5% of complaints end with relief. Cards lead at 30.3% and accounts follow at 17.0%. Vehicle loans (8.8%), money transfer (6.8%), mortgages (4.6%) and student loans (1.6%) are far lower. Money transfer is a high-volume product (115,255 complaints) yet 93% of its complaints close without relief. On timeliness, student loans are the outlier at 71.3% against 97.6% to 99.3% for every other product. They are 6.6% of complaints but roughly 62% of all late responses (about 11,000 of about 18,000, estimated from rounded percentages).

Recommendation: Escalate student-loan servicer performance with clear response-time targets and weekly monitoring. Review fraud and transaction-dispute outcomes in digital payments, where relief is rare. Check whether the 0.00% servicer entry is a placeholder label before drawing conclusions about a single company.

Chart 6: Complaints by channel

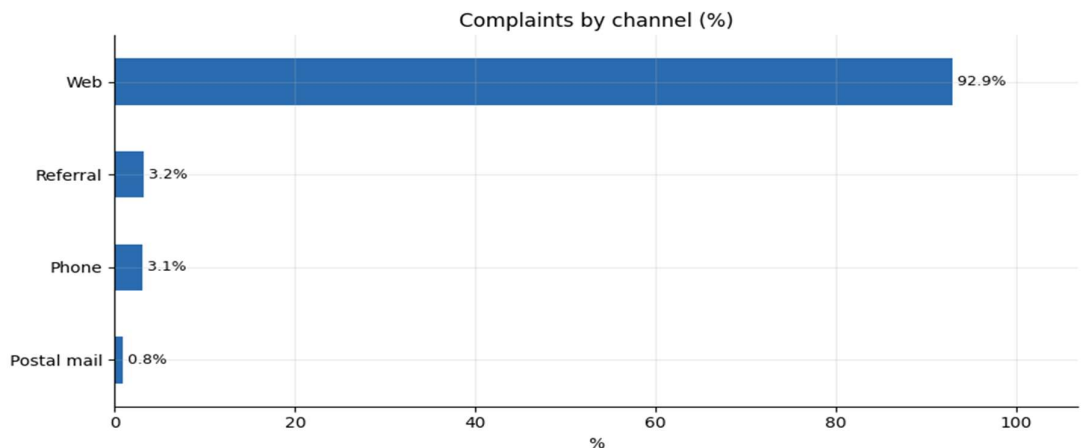


Figure 6: Complaints by channel (%)

Insight: Web accounts for 92.9% of complaints, Referral 3.2%, Phone 3.1% and Postal mail 0.8%. The CFPB forwards 88.5% of complaints to the company on the day received, and only 4.8% take more than seven days, so intake is not the bottleneck.

Recommendation: Treat complaint handling as digital-first (in-app capture, automatic triage and status tracking) while keeping phone and mail available for customers with limited access. Focus improvement effort on company response, not on routing.

Chart 7: Top 10 states

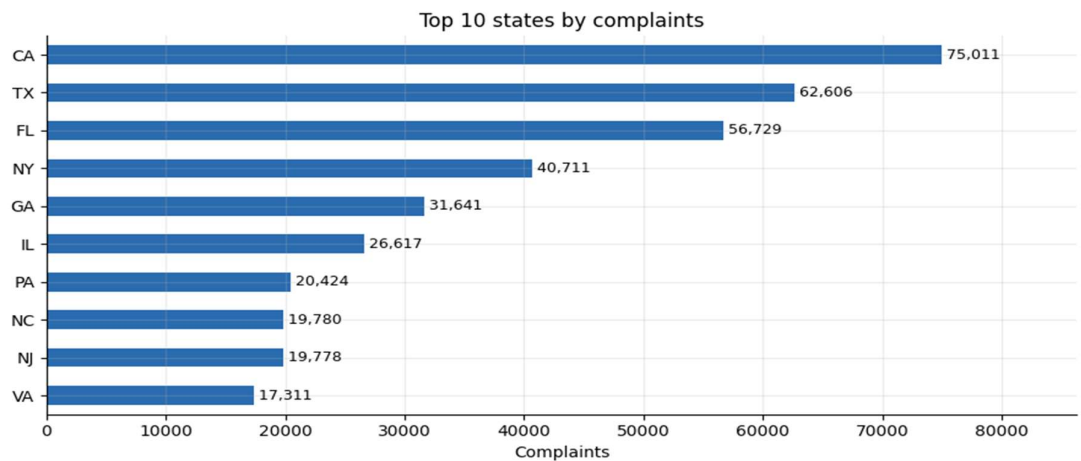


Figure 7: Top 10 states by complaints

Insight: California (75,011), Texas (62,606), Florida (56,729), New York (40,711) and Georgia (31,641) lead. The top four hold 39.4% and the top ten 62.2% of all complaints. Georgia stands out given its population, which should be confirmed with a per-capita analysis.

Recommendation: Normalise per 100,000 residents before targeting regions. Concentrate consumer-education and support capacity in the highest-volume states, and investigate states that stand out per capita.

Peak-month investigation (January 2025)

Top companies	Complaints	Top issues	Complaints
Block, Inc.	31,223	Other transaction problem	42,521
Early Warning Services, LLC	16,723	Managing an account	8,232
Navy Federal Credit Union	7,775	Problem caused by your funds being low	7,570
Capital One Financial Corporation	5,955	Fraud or scam	2,363
JPMorgan Chase & Co.	2,027	Problem with a company's investigation into an existing problem	1,712

Insight: Money transfer and digital products produced 49,743 of the month's 84,295 complaints (59%).

11. Dashboard Development

Tool: Microsoft Power BI Desktop. **Source:** `complaints_clean.csv` (596,121 rows).

11.1 Measures (DAX)

Total Complaints	= COUNTROWS(complaints_clean)
Timely Response %	= DIVIDE(SUM(complaints_clean[timely_flag]), [Total Complaints])
Relief Rate %	= DIVIDE(SUM(complaints_clean[relief_flag]), [Total Complaints])
Companies	= DISTINCTCOUNT(complaints_clean[company])
Late Responses	= [Total Complaints] - SUM(complaints_clean[timely_flag])

11.2 Visuals

Visual	Fields	Purpose
Five KPI cards	Total Complaints, Timely Response %, Relief Rate %, Companies, Late Responses	Headline numbers
Bar chart	Company by Total Complaints	Who gets the most complaints
Bar chart	Product group by Total Complaints	What they complain about
Bar chart	Issue by Total Complaints	Why they complain
Line chart	Month by Total Complaints	Trend and the January 2025 spike
Donut chart	Channel by Total Complaints	How customers complain
Table	Product group, Total Complaints, Timely %, Relief %	Response quality
Slicers	State, Year, Product group	Interactive filtering

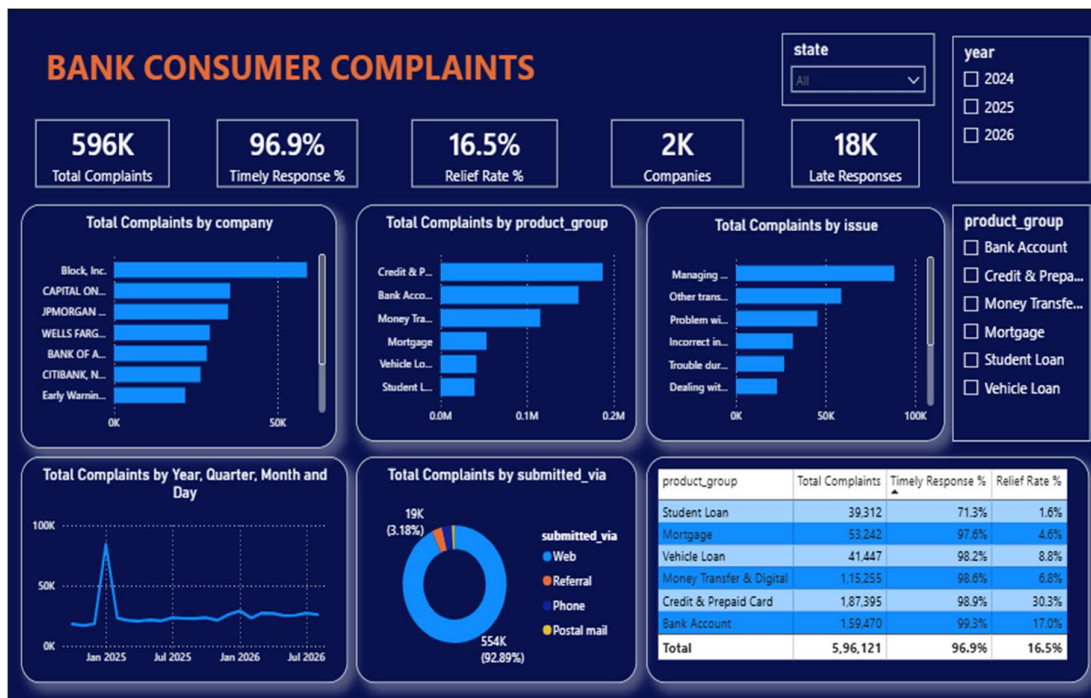


Figure 8: One-page Power BI dashboard

11.3 Validation against the Python analysis

Measure	Python result	Dashboard
Total complaints	596,121	596,121
Timely response	96.9%	96.9%
Relief rate	16.5%	16.5%
Student Loan row	39,312 / 71.3% / 1.6%	39,312 / 71.3% / 1.6%
Channel share (Web)	92.9%	92.89%

Every product-group row in the dashboard table matches the Python output, so the two analyses agree.

12. Business Recommendations

Rank	Recommendation	Evidence	Suggested owner	KPI to track
1	Fix account-management and transaction problems with self-service tools for holds, closures and transaction errors, clearer error messages and status tracking	"Managing an account" and "Other transaction problem" make up 24.7% of complaints	Product and Customer Experience	Complaints per 1,000 customers for these issues
2	Close the student-loan response gap with response-time targets, escalation paths and weekly monitoring for servicers	Timely rate 71.3% against 97.6% or more elsewhere; MOHELA 45.5%; about 62% of late responses come from 6.6% of complaints	Compliance and Operations	Timely Response % by servicer
3	Add anomaly alerts for complaint surges and separate campaign-driven surges from real service failures	January 2025 was 3.6 times typical; Block and Early Warning Services made up 57%	Risk and BI team	Alert response time; surge classification
4	Improve card-dispute handling and credit-report data quality	"Problem with a purchase shown on your statement" 45,448; "Incorrect information on your report" 31,815	Cards and Compliance	Dispute resolution days; reporting-error complaints
5	Strengthen fraud and scam protection in digital payments with in-app warnings, faster unauthorised-transaction investigations and live support	Money transfer: 115,255 complaints at 6.8% relief; Fraud or scam 20,732	Digital Payments and Fraud	Fraud complaints; relief rate
6	Help borrowers early with proactive hardship outreach for mortgage and vehicle borrowers	Mortgage "Trouble during payment process" 26,934; vehicle "Repossession" 11,235	Lending and Collections	Delinquency-related complaints
7	Build digital-first complaint handling with in-app capture, chat triage and status updates, keeping phone and mail available	Web is 92.9% of complaints	Customer Experience	Web resolution time; first-contact resolution
8	Use fair benchmarks by normalising complaints per customer and per capita and reporting with and without January 2025	Raw counts favour large firms; 52.9% of Block's complaints came in one month	Analytics team	Complaints per 1,000 customers; per 100,000 residents

13. Business Impact

The figures below are **illustrative estimates** calculated from this dataset under stated assumptions. They show the scale of potential benefit and are not forecasts.

Scenario	Assumption	Estimated effect
Reduce the top two issues (Managing an account; Other transaction problem)	10% fewer complaints	About 14,700 fewer complaints (2.5% of 596,121)
Bring student-loan timely response to about 98%	Raise 71.3% to 98.0%	About 10,500 fewer late responses; overall timely rate rises from 96.9% to roughly 98.7%
Raise mortgage relief to the vehicle-loan level	4.6% to 8.8% on 53,242 complaints	About 2,200 more customers receiving relief
Detect surges early	Alert at 3 times normal volume	Faster separation of campaign-driven spikes from real failures, avoiding misreading roughly 61,000 extra complaints in one month

Qualitative impact: lower regulatory and reputational risk, lower handling cost per complaint, better customer trust, and faster decisions because leaders see the same numbers on one page.

Method note: late-response estimates use percentages rounded to one decimal place, so treat them as approximate.

14. Conclusion and Future Scope

Conclusion

Across 596,121 complaints from October 2024 to August 2026, three product groups (cards, bank accounts and digital payments) hold 77.5% of complaints, and three everyday issues (account management, transaction problems and card-statement disputes) make up 32.3%. Overall response quality is high at 96.9% timely, but **student loans stand out sharply for late responses (71.3% timely) and relief is rare outside cards and accounts.**

The January 2025 spike shows why raw counts can mislead: two companies and one issue made up most of that month, and public reporting ties it to enforcement news and social media activity. Reporting with and without such spikes, and normalising by customer base, is essential for fair decisions.

The project also shows careful data handling. Duplicates caused by the API's inclusive date range were removed, and the incomplete latest month was excluded after daily counts proved it was under-reported.

Future scope

1. **Text analytics** on complaint narratives (for consenting consumers) with topic modelling and sentiment.
2. **Forecasting** monthly volume, with January 2025 handled as an event.
3. **Predictive models** that classify which complaints are likely to receive relief or a late response, using `relief_flag` and `timely_flag` as targets.
4. **More products**, including credit reporting and debt collection as a separate analysis.
5. **An India comparison** against RBI Ombudsman annual-report statistics.
6. **Vulnerable-consumer analysis** using the Older American and Servicemember tags.